

Curriculum Stories

اللغة الإنجليزية

الصف التاسع

Term 1

One story for every lesson: enjoy the story and learn the whole lesson

19 stories

How to use this book

📚 One story per lesson

Each story teaches a whole lesson from your book, in the same order.

🖍️ Highlighted words

Highlighted words are the key words of the lesson.

💡 Facts

Small boxes inside the story give facts you should remember.

📖 Words

At the end of each story you find the key words with their meaning in Arabic.

🌟 What did I learn?

A short list of what the lesson teaches. Read it to check yourself.

🤔 Little questions

Try to answer alone, then look at the answer.

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Lesson 0-1 · Starter: Fun times!

The Best Day Competition

Competition story · Starter

👥 Hamed (14, from Ibri), his cousin Majid, and their English teacher Mr Saif

On the first day of Grade 9, Mr Saif wrote on the board: "**Best Day Competition**. Write a **blog post** about your best moment of the summer. The winner's post goes on the school website!"

Hamed looked at his cousin Majid. "My summer was boring," he said. "I spent all my **free time** at home."

"That's not true," said Majid. "Remember the science day at the museum? And the trip to the **countryside**?"

Reading the old posts

Mr Saif showed the class four posts from last year.

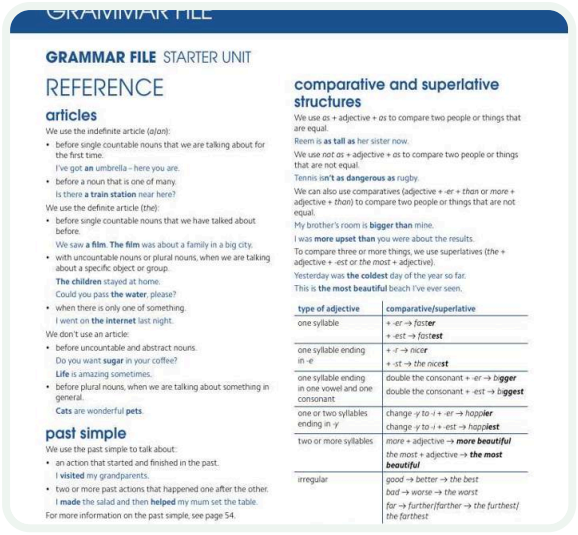
Dana **visited** a modern museum and **saw** a robot working. Ryan **got** a kitten from his grandparents. Hashim **spent** his birthday with friends at the beach. Nancy **went** on a school trip to Paris.

"Look at the verbs," said Mr Saif. "They are in the **past simple**. We use it for **finished actions in the past**. Regular verbs add **-ed**: play → played, visit → visited. But some verbs are irregular: go → **went**, see → **saw**, eat → **ate**. You can find them in the Irregular verbs table on page 49."

Majid laughed. "Last year I wrote 'I goed to the beach'!"

"And the correct form is…?"

"I **went** to the beach!"



GRAMMAR FILE STARTER UNIT

REFERENCE

articles

We use the indefinite article (*a*/*an*):

- before single countable nouns that we are talking about for the first time.
  I've got **an** umbrella – here you are.
- before a noun that is one of many.
  Is there **a train station** near here?

We use the definite article (*the*):

- before single countable nouns that we have talked about before.
  We saw **a film**. **The film** was about a family in a big city.
- with uncountable nouns or plural nouns, when we are talking about a specific object or group.
  The children stayed at home.
  Could you pass **the water**, please?
- when there is only one of something.
  I went on **the internet** last night.

We don't use an article:

- before uncountable and abstract nouns.
  Do you want **sugar** in your coffee?
  Life is amazing sometimes.
- before plural nouns, when we are talking about something in general.
  Cats are wonderful **pets**.

past simple

We use the past simple to talk about:

- an action that started and finished in the past.
  I **visited** my grandparents.
- two or more past actions that happened one after the other.
  I **made** the salad and then **helped** my mum set the table.

For more information on the past simple, see page 54.

comparative and superlative structures

We use *as* + adjective + *as* to compare two people or things that are equal.
Reem is **as tall as** her sister now.
We use *not as* + adjective + *as* to compare two people or things that are not equal.
Tennis isn't **as dangerous as** rugby.
We can also use comparatives (adjective + *-er* + *than* or *more* + adjective + *than*) to compare two people or things that are not equal.
My brother's room is **bigger than** mine.
I was **more upset than** you were about the results.
To compare three or more things, we use superlatives (*the* + adjective + *-est* or *the most* + adjective).
Yesterday was **the coldest** day of the year so far.
This is **the most beautiful** beach I've ever seen.

type of adjective	comparative/superlative
one syllable	+ *-er* → fast**er** + *-est* → fast**est**
one syllable ending in *-e*	+ *-r* → nice**r** + *-st* → the nice**st**
one syllable ending in one vowel and one consonant	double the consonant + *-er* → b**igger** double the consonant + *-est* → b**iggest**
one or two syllables ending in *-y*	change *-y* to *-i* + *-er* → happ**ier** change *-y* to *-i* + *-est* → happ**iest**
two or more syllables	*more* + adjective → ***more beautiful*** *the most* + adjective → ***the most beautiful***
irregular	*good* → *better* → *the best* *bad* → *worse* → *the worst* *far* → *further/farther* → *the furthest/ the farthest*

Grammar file: articles, past simple and comparatives

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a, an or the?

Hamed started to write: "I saw **a** robot at the museum. **The** robot could talk."

"Good," said Mr Saif. "**A** or **an** is for the first time we talk about a single countable noun: I've got **an** umbrella. **The** is for something we talked about before, or something that is only one, like **the** Moon. And we use **no article** with uncountable and plural nouns in general."

"So I can't write 'The life is amazing'?"

"No. Write: **Life** is amazing. **Cats** are wonderful pets."

Faster, happier, the best

Majid read his sentence: "The trip was more good than the museum."

Mr Saif smiled. "Let's check comparatives and superlatives. One syllable: fast → fast**er** → the fast**est**. Ending in -y: happy → happ**ier** → the happ**iest**. Two or more syllables: **more** beautiful → **the most** beautiful. And irregular: good → **better** → **the best**, bad → **worse** → **the worst**."

"So: The trip was **better** than the museum!"

"And don't say 'more tall'. Say **taller**. You can also say: Reem is **as tall as** her sister."

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The best moment

That evening, Hamed asked himself four questions: **When? What did you do? What skills did you use? Why was it the best?**

Then he wrote:

"It was the hottest day of the summer, but it was the best day of my life. In the countryside near Ibri, my uncle was the **organiser** of a tree-planting day. At first I felt **nervous** because I didn't know anyone. Then I used my skills: I carried water and helped the younger boys. We planted fifty trees. It was a **perfect** day and a great **experience**. I was proud because it was a **successful** day for our village."

The next week Mr Saif read the winner's name. "Hamed! Your post was the most interesting."

Hamed smiled. He didn't need a trip to Paris. He needed a good story and the past simple.

📖 Words from the story

free time وقت الفراغ	**blog post** تدوينة
celebrate يحتفل	**experience** تجربة
countryside الريف	**perfect** مثالي
advert إعلان	**organiser** منظِّم
nervous متوتر	**successful** ناجح

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ We use a or an the first time we talk about a single countable noun
- ✔ We use the for something we talked about before or something that is only one, like the Moon
- ✔ We use no article with uncountable and plural nouns in general: Life is amazing
- ✔ The past simple is for finished actions: play → played, go → went, see → saw, eat → ate
- ✔ Comparatives: faster, happier, more beautiful, and irregular good → better → the best
- ✔ as + adjective + as: Reem is as tall as her sister
- ✔ Plan your best moment: When? What? Skills? Why?

🤔 Little questions

1. What is the past simple of see?
   Answer: saw
2. What is the superlative of good?
   Answer: the best
3. Which article do we use with Moon?
   Answer: the
4. Correct this: She is more tall than me.
   Answer: She is taller than me.
5. Correct this: I goed to the beach.
   Answer: I went to the beach.

Lesson 1-1 · Identity: Reading – Photo boards

Six Photos of Me

Mystery story · Unit 1: Identity

👥 Hamed and his classmates, and Mr Saif

Mr Saif put four **photo boards** on the classroom wall. Each board had five or six photos, but there were no names.

"A photo board shows **who you are**," he said. "Where you live, your family, your **hobbies**, your interests and your **dreams**. This is your **identity**: your **personality**, your family, your hobbies and your dreams. Your job is to be detectives. Match each board with the right person."



Unit 1 opener: Be who you are

The four profiles

Mr Saif gave the class four short profiles.

Osama lives with his family in Muscat. He loves football and he's having karate lessons.

Hana comes from a very small village and likes cooking for her family.

Basil lives near the mountains and wants to be a film star.

Riley lives with his grandparents by the coast and loves the sea.

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Board A

Board A had a photo of a big **stadium**, a football shirt and a busy street.

"It's Riley!" said Majid. "There's a football shirt."

"Wait," said Hamed. "Riley loves the sea. There is no sea here. Look at the street: it's very **crowded**, with a lot of people. That's a big city. And the stadium is a large building where sports games take place. I think it's Osama: he lives in Muscat and he loves football."

"Check the last photo," said Mr Saif.

It was a karate belt. "Yes! Osama is learning karate!"

"Good work," said Mr Saif. "Here is a **study tip**: in multiple matching, make sure **all** the information matches, not just some of it. Majid chose Riley because of one word. Don't do that!"

Boards B, C and D

Board B showed a green **valley**, an area of land between hills and mountains, and in the **background**, high mountains. The background is the area behind the main thing you are looking at. There was also a cinema ticket and a film poster.

"Basil," said Hamed. "He lives near the mountains and he wants to be a film star."

Board C showed small houses, a kitchen and a plate of rice. "Hana! She comes from a small village and likes cooking."

Board D showed the beach, a boat and an old man and woman smiling. "Riley, with his grandparents by the coast."

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Detectives' secrets

"How did you find the answers?" asked Mr Saif.

Hamed explained: "First, I underlined the **key words** in each profile: Muscat, karate, village, cooking, mountains, film star. Then I read every option before I chose. And I looked for **synonyms**. The profile says 'by the coast', and the photo shows the beach. Different words, same meaning."

"Excellent. **Identity is like a puzzle: you need all of the pieces to complete the picture.**"

My own board

For homework, Hamed planned his own photo board. He chose six photos: the old fort in Ibri, his family at dinner, his football, a book about space, his grandfather's date farm, and a picture of a rocket. "That's my dream," he said. "I want to work in space science one day."

He made a **cover** for his board, the outside part, like the cover of a book, and wrote on it: "Be who you are."

📖 Words from the story

identity الهوية	**personality** الشخصية
photo board لوحة صور	**valley** وادٍ
crowded مزدحم	**cover** غلاف
background الخلفية	**stadium** ملعب / استاد
hobby هواية	**dream** حلم

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Identity is who you are: your personality, family, hobbies and dreams
- ✔ A photo board is five or six photos that show who you are
- ✔ Osama lives in Muscat, loves football and is having karate lessons
- ✔ In multiple matching, ALL the information must match, not just one word
- ✔ Underline key words and read every option before you choose
- ✔ Look for synonyms: by the coast is like the beach
- ✔ valley = land between hills and mountains, crowded = with a lot of people, stadium = a large building for sports games

🤔 Little questions

1. What is a photo board?
   Answer: Five or six photos that show who you are
2. What does crowded mean?
   Answer: with a lot of people
3. Where does Osama live?
   Answer: in Muscat
4. What is a valley?
   Answer: an area of land between hills and mountains
5. Why was Majid's first answer wrong?
   Answer: He chose it because only one word matched



Lesson 1-2 · Grammar: Talking about the present

Grandpa's Two Kinds of Days

Family story | Unit 1: Identity

👥 Hamed, his grandfather (Jaddi Salim), and Majid

This summer Hamed **is living** with his grandfather on the date farm, but he **goes** back home every weekend. One morning, Majid called him.

"What **are you doing** at the moment?"

"I'm **helping** Grandpa with the palm trees. What about you?"

"I'm **watching** TV. As usual!"

Hamed laughed, but then he stopped. "Why did I say 'I'm helping' and you said 'as usual'? Our teacher told us about two tenses."

His grandfather put down his basket. "Sit down. I don't speak English very well, but I know about **two kinds of days**."

Days that are always the same

"Some things in my life are **permanent**," said Grandpa. "I **live** on this farm. I **wake up** before Fajr every day. I **water** the trees every evening. These are my **habits**."

Hamed opened his notebook. "This is the **present simple**! For permanent states, habits and repeated actions. I live, I wake up. And with he, she, it, we add -s: Grandpa **lives** on a farm. He **waters** the trees."

"And when you say no?"

"Don't or doesn't + verb: He **doesn't** sleep late. And questions: **Does** he work every day? Yes, he does!"

"Time words help you," Hamed added. "**always, usually, every day** → present simple."

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Days that are different

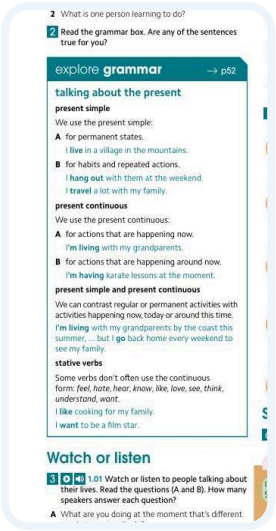
"But some things are **temporary**," said Grandpa. "This month **I'm building** a new wall for the farm, because the old one fell down."

"That's the **present continuous**!" said Hamed. "**am, is, are + verb-ing**. For actions happening **now**: I'm helping Grandpa. And for actions happening **around now**, like this month: Majid **is having** karate lessons **at the moment**."

"So 'I'm living with my grandfather' is temporary?"

"Yes! **Regular = present simple, temporary = present continuous.** Listen: I'm living with my grandfather this summer, but I go back home every weekend."

"**now, at the moment, this week** → present continuous," he wrote.


2 What is one person learning to do?

2 Read the grammar box. Are any of the sentences true for you?

explore **grammar** → p52

talking about the present

present simple

We use the present simple:

A for permanent states.
I **live** in a village in the mountains.

B for habits and repeated actions.
I **hang out** with them at the weekend.
I **travel** a lot with my family.

present continuous

We use the present continuous:

A for actions that are happening now.
I'm **living** with my grandparents.

B for actions that are happening around now.
I'm **having** karate lessons at the moment.

present simple and present continuous

We can contrast regular or permanent activities with activities happening now, today or around this time.
I'm **living** with my grandparents by the coast this summer, ... but I **go** back home every weekend to see my family.

stative verbs

Some verbs don't often use the continuous form: *feel, hate, hear, know, like, love, see, think, understand, want.*
I **like** cooking for my family.
I **want** to be a film star.

Watch or listen

3 1.01 Watch or listen to people talking about their lives. Read the questions (A and B). How many speakers answer each question?

A What are you doing at the moment that's different.

Explore grammar: talking about the present

The strange verbs

In the evening Majid came to the farm. He sat with Hamed under the palm trees.

"I'm knowing the answer to your grandpa's riddle!" Majid said.

Hamed shook his head. "No, no. **Know** is a **stative verb**. We don't usually use it in the continuous form. Say: **I know** the answer."

"Which other verbs are stative?"

Hamed counted: "**feel, hate, hear, know, like, love, see, think, understand, want**. So: I **like** cooking. I **want** to be a film star."

"But my teacher says 'I'm thinking'."

"Yes, some can be continuous with a different meaning. **I'm thinking** about my answer means I'm considering it. But **I think** it's a good idea means it's my opinion."

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Grandpa's riddle

Grandpa smiled. "Now, the riddle. What **is** always in front of you but you can never see it?"

The boys **were** quiet. Majid **was thinking**. Hamed **was looking** at the sky.

"The future!" said Hamed.

"Correct," said Grandpa. "And now **I'm going** to make coffee, because I **always** make coffee at sunset."

Hamed wrote one more line in his notebook: "She **goes** to school every day, not 'She go'. Remember the -s!"

> 💡 Present simple = habits and permanent states. Present continuous = now and temporary.

📖 Words from the story

permanent دائم	**temporary** مؤقت
habit عادة	**at the moment** في الوقت الحالي
stative verb فعل حالة	**contrast** يقارن

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ The present simple is for permanent states, habits and repeated actions: I live in a village
- ✔ Form: I play, he plays, don't or doesn't + verb, Do or Does in questions
- ✔ The present continuous is for actions now or around now: am, is, are + verb-ing
- ✔ Regular means present simple and temporary means present continuous
- ✔ always, usually, every day go with the present simple, now, at the moment, this week with the present continuous
- ✔ Stative verbs are not usually continuous: feel, hate, hear, know, like, love, see, think, understand, want
- ✔ I'm thinking about my answer means I'm considering it

🤔 Little questions

1. Which tense do we use for habits?
   Answer: present simple
2. What is the form of the present continuous?
   Answer: am/is/are + verb-ing
3. Is know a stative verb?
   Answer: yes
4. Complete: What ___ (you / do) at the moment?
   Answer: are you doing
5. Correct this: She go to school every day.
   Answer: She goes to school every day.

Lesson 1-3 · Vocabulary: Personality adjectives

The Team That Was Too Different

School story · Unit 1: Identity

👥 Hamed, Majid, Talal, Yousuf and Sami, a school science-fair team

Mr Saif put five boys in one team for the school science fair: Hamed, Majid, Talal, Yousuf and Sami.

"This team will never work," said Majid. "We are all too different!"

"Different is good," said Mr Saif. "Describe your team with **personality adjectives**."

Five personalities

Majid started. "**Talal** always gets good marks. He's very **clever**. **Yousuf** makes everyone laugh. He's so **funny**. **Sami** is **shy**: he's nervous with people he doesn't know. And **Hamed** is **sociable**: he enjoys spending time with other people."

"And you?" asked Hamed.

"I'm **sporty**. I play football every day. And I'm **calm**: relaxed and not angry."

"And sometimes **lazy**!" said Yousuf. "You don't like working!"

Everyone laughed. Majid smiled. "OK, sometimes."

"Let's make two groups," said Talal. "Positive adjectives: clever, **confident**, funny, sociable, calm, sporty. Negative adjectives: lazy, **rude**, **noisy**, **unpleasant**."

"And **serious**?" asked Sami quietly.

"Serious is fine. It means you think carefully about things."

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Good at, keen on, afraid of

"Now," said Mr Saif, "what is each person good at? Use **adjective + preposition** collocations."

He wrote on the board: good / brilliant **at** – bad / terrible **at** – bored / fed up **with** – excited **about** – interested **in** – afraid / frightened **of** – keen **on**.



Explore language: adjective + preposition collocations

"Talal is brilliant **at** maths," said Hamed.

"Sami is interested **in** drawing," said Yousuf.

"Interesting in drawing?" asked Majid.

"No! **Interested in**. Interesting is for things: a book is interesting. Interested is for people."

"I'm keen **on** football and I'm terrible **at** writing reports," said Majid. "I'm also afraid **of** speaking in front of the judges."

"And I'm fed up **with** this song!" said Yousuf, and he switched off the radio.

Mr Saif added: "After the preposition we use a **noun**: She's interested **in languages**. Or an **-ing** form: Frank's brilliant **at cooking**."

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The plan

Hamed had an idea. "Talal is clever, so he does the science. Sami is good at drawing, so he makes the poster. Yousuf is funny and confident, so he talks to the judges. Majid is sporty, so he carries the heavy model! And I'm sociable, so I organise the team."

"What about me being afraid of the judges?" asked Majid.

"You don't need to speak. You're calm, so you answer only the hard questions."

How we change

At the fair, the judges asked, "Why does your team work so well?"

Sami surprised everyone. He stood up and said, "From about thirteen, we notice how we behave in different situations. We become **more serious** about our work and study. Friends affect our behaviour, but we stay the same, and we choose friends who are like us. But in our team, we chose friends who are **different** from us."

The team won second prize. Majid looked at Sami. "You're not shy anymore!"

Sami smiled. "I'm still shy. But today I was confident."

> 💡 Learn adjectives with their prepositions as one chunk: interested in, keen on, afraid of, good at.

📖 Words from the story

clever ذكي	**confident** واثق بنفسه
funny مضحك	**sociable** اجتماعي
sporty رياضي	**lazy** كسول
unpleasant غير لطيف	**noisy** مزعج / صاخب
rude وقح / غير مهذب	**calm** هادئ
serious جاد	**shy** خجول

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Sociable = enjoys spending time with other people, funny = makes people laugh, clever = intelligent
- ✔ Shy = nervous with people you don't know, calm = relaxed and not angry, lazy = doesn't like working
- ✔ Positive adjectives: clever, funny, confident. Negative: lazy, rude, noisy, unpleasant
- ✔ Collocations: good at, bad at, fed up with, excited about, interested in, afraid of, keen on
- ✔ After the preposition use a noun or an -ing form: brilliant at cooking
- ✔ From about thirteen we become more serious, and friends affect our behaviour

🤔 Little questions

1. What is the opposite of confident?
   Answer: shy
2. Which preposition comes after keen?
   Answer: on

3. Which preposition comes after afraid?
   Answer: of
4. Correct this: I'm interesting in drawing.
   Answer: I'm interested in drawing.
5. Correct this: She's good in maths.
   Answer: She's good at maths.



Lesson 1-4 · Listening & Speaking: Cities and personal information

The Megacity Radio Show

Radio story · Unit 1: Identity

👥 Hamed and Majid on the school radio, and their guests

Hamed and Majid had a new job: presenters on the school radio. Their first show was about **cities**.

"Good morning!" said Hamed. "Today we have two guests. They are talking about a **megacity**. A megacity is a city with **more than ten million people** living in it."

Agree or disagree?

The first guest said: "I love big cities. There's always something to do."

The second guest said: "Hmm, it's exciting, but I prefer quiet places."

Majid wrote in his notebook: "**disagree**". Then he whispered to Hamed: "Our teacher's **study tip**: speakers may use **different words** to give the same idea. Listen to **both** speakers before you choose. And look at the question first: is it about agreement, a suggestion or feelings?"

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Always, usually, never

"How often do you visit the city?" Hamed asked the first guest.

"I **often** go on foot to the market. And I **usually** take the bus to work."

"And you?" he asked the second guest.

"I **rarely** go there. I hate summer there – it's **always** so hot!"

After the show, Mr Saif said, "Did you notice the **adverbs of frequency**? always, usually, often, sometimes, rarely, never. They go **after** the verb **be**: It's **always** so hot! She is **never** late. But they go **before** other main verbs: I **often** go on foot. I **always** go to school by bus."

Majid laughed. "In the practice show I said 'I go always'!"


explore **grammar** → p52

adverbs of frequency, time phrases

Adverbs of frequency go **after** the verb *be*.

I hate winter – it's **always** so cold!

Adverbs of frequency go **before** other main verbs.

I **often go** on foot.

Other time expressions usually go **at the end** of a sentence.

Give me sunshine and heat **every day**!

8 Put the words in the correct order to make sentences.

Explore grammar: adverbs of frequency and time phrases

Time phrases

"And time phrases?" asked Hamed.

"**every day, every week, once a month, twice a year, from time to time, now and then, most days**. They usually go at the **end** of the sentence: Give me sunshine **every day**! We can see a full moon **once a month**."

"**Once** is one time, and **twice** is two times," said Majid.

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The competition call

In the second part of the show, a boy phoned to win a prize.

"What's your full name?" asked Majid.

"Fares Al Hinai."

"And your **surname**? How do you spell it?"

"H-I-N-A-I."

"What's your **address**? Street and house number, town and **postcode**, please."

"House 12, Al Nahda Street, Ibri, postcode 516."

"And your email?"

"fares.h at mail dot om."

"Great. Now, the question: What do you enjoy doing in your free time?"

"Reading."

Hamed waited. Then he said, "Fares, don't just say one word. Give a **reason** and an **example**."

"OK. I enjoy reading **because** it helps me relax. **For example**, I read stories at night. **One reason is that** books teach me new words."

"Perfect! You win!"

After the show

Mr Saif was happy. "When you speak, give reasons with **because**, **as**, **one reason is (that)**. And give examples with **for example**. A Yes or No answer is not enough."

Hamed wrote: "I **always** prepare my questions. I'm **never** late for the show. We have a show **twice a week**."

> 💡 Adverbs of frequency: after be, before other verbs. Time phrases: at the end.

📖 Words from the story

megacity مدينة ضخمة يزيد سكانها عن عشرة ملايين	**surname** اسم العائلة
address العنوان	**postcode** الرمز البريدي
reason سبب	**for example** على سبيل المثال
once مرة واحدة	**twice** مرتين
rarely نادرًا	

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ A megacity is a city with more than ten million people
- ✔ In multiple choice listening, speakers use different words for the same idea, so listen to both speakers
- ✔ Adverbs of frequency: always, usually, often, sometimes, rarely, never
- ✔ They go after be (It's always cold) and before main verbs (I often go on foot)
- ✔ Time phrases like every day, once a month, now and then usually go at the end
- ✔ Personal information: full name, surname, address, postcode, email, spelling
- ✔ Give reasons with because, as, one reason is that, and examples with for example

🤔 Little questions

1. Where does always go with be?
   Answer: after be
2. What is a megacity?
   Answer: a city with more than ten million people
3. Give a phrase for reasons.
   Answer: one reason is that
4. Correct this: I go always to school by bus.
   Answer: I always go to school by bus.
5. Correct this: She is late never.
   Answer: She is never late.

Lesson 1-5 · Writing: An email about yourself

Rahaf's Village on TV

True-to-life story | Unit 1: Identity

👥 Hamed, his sister Rahaf's email as a model, and Mr Saif

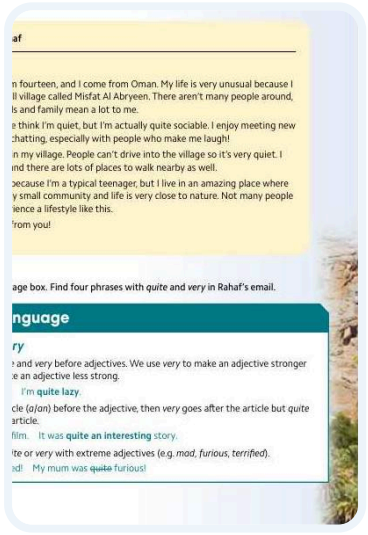
Mr Saif showed the class an **advert** from a TV **programme** called **Tell us about you!**

"The programme wants teenagers with an interesting **lifestyle**. You must write an email of about **100 words**. Let's read a good example first. It's from a girl called Rahaf."

Rahaf's email

Mr Saif read it aloud:

"Hello! I'm Rahaf, I'm fourteen and I come from Oman, from the village of Misfat Al Abryeen. Some people think I'm quiet, but I'm actually quite sociable. I love living in my village and I love hiking. I'm a typical teenager, but I live in an amazing place."



Rahaf's email and the language box: quite and very

"Look at her plan," said Mr Saif. "**Paragraph 1**: tell them about yourself. **Paragraph 2**: your personality. **Paragraph 3**: what you enjoy. **Paragraph 4**: why they should choose you. One paragraph for each point."

"What does **typical** mean?" asked Majid.

"Normal, like most teenagers. And Rahaf's village is **remote**: far from big cities. In some mountain areas in Oman, water flows underground, just by gravity, in the **aflaj**."

❁ ❁ ❁

Quite or very?

"Now look at two little words," said Mr Saif. "**Very** makes an adjective **stronger**: He's **very** funny. **Quite** makes an adjective **less strong**: I'm **quite** lazy."

"So Rahaf is a little sociable, not very sociable?"

"Exactly. Now be careful with **a** and **an**. **Very** goes **after** a/an: It's **a very** good film. **Quite** goes **before** a/an: It was **quite an** interesting story."

Majid read his sentence: "It was a quite interesting story."

"Correct it."

"It was **quite an** interesting story!"

"And never use very with **extreme adjectives**. Don't say 'very terrified' or 'very furious'. Say: I was **terrified**! I was **furious**!"

Joining ideas

"Use **and, but, or, because, so** to join your ideas," said Mr Saif. "For example: I like judo. I don't enjoy playing tennis."

"I like judo, **but** I don't enjoy playing tennis," said Hamed.

❁ ❁ ❁

Hamed's email

Hamed made notes first: Ibri, the old fort, palm trees, football, grandfather's farm. Then he wrote:

> "Hi! My name is Hamed. I'm fourteen and I come from Ibri, in Oman. My friends say I'm very sociable, and I'm quite funny too. I'm really **keen on** football and I help my grandfather on his date farm every weekend. I **can't stand** being inside all day, so I love the open desert. I'm a typical teenager, but my town has a 4,000-year-old history, and I want to show it to you!"

"Now **check**," said Mr Saif. "Plan → write → check."

Hamed checked with the **Improve it** questions: Did I write about all four points? Yes. Does each point have extra information? Yes. Did I use quite and very? Yes!

Mr Saif smiled. "Write about **all** the content points, say what you like and **why**, and give extra information. You did it."

💡 very = stronger, quite = less strong. a very good film, quite an interesting story.

📖 Words from the story

advert إعلان	**programme** برنامج
typical نموذجي / عادي	**lifestyle** نمط الحياة
remote بعيد / نائي	**keen on** مولع بـ
can't stand لا يطيق	**quite** إلى حد ما
very جدًا	

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ An email about yourself has four paragraphs: about you, your personality, what you enjoy, why they should choose you
- ✔ Very makes an adjective stronger and quite makes it less strong
- ✔ very goes after a or an (a very good film) and quite goes before (quite an interesting story)
- ✔ Don't use very with extreme adjectives: say I was furious, not very furious
- ✔ Join ideas with and, but, or, because, so
- ✔ Plan, write, then check that you covered all the points
- ✔ In some mountain areas in Oman, water flows underground by gravity in the aflaj

🤔 Little questions

1. Which word makes an adjective stronger?
   Answer: very
2. Where does quite go with a/an?
   Answer: before a/an
3. How many words should the email be?
   Answer: about 100
4. Correct this: It's very a good film.
   Answer: It's a very good film.
5. Join: I like judo. I don't enjoy tennis.
   Answer: I like judo, but I don't enjoy tennis.

Lesson 1-6 · Switch on & Unit check: Learning is fun

Uncle Khalfan Goes Back to Class

Family story | Unit 1: Identity

👥 Hamed, his uncle Khalfan (45), and Majid

Uncle Khalfan was forty-five years old. One evening he came home with a new bag and a big smile.

"I **am taking** an **evening class**," he said. "I want to learn to **repair** cars myself."

Hamed and Majid looked at each other. "But Uncle, you're... old!"

Uncle Khalfan laughed. "You can **keep learning all through your life**. Tomorrow we're watching a video in my class called **Learning is fun**. Come and see."

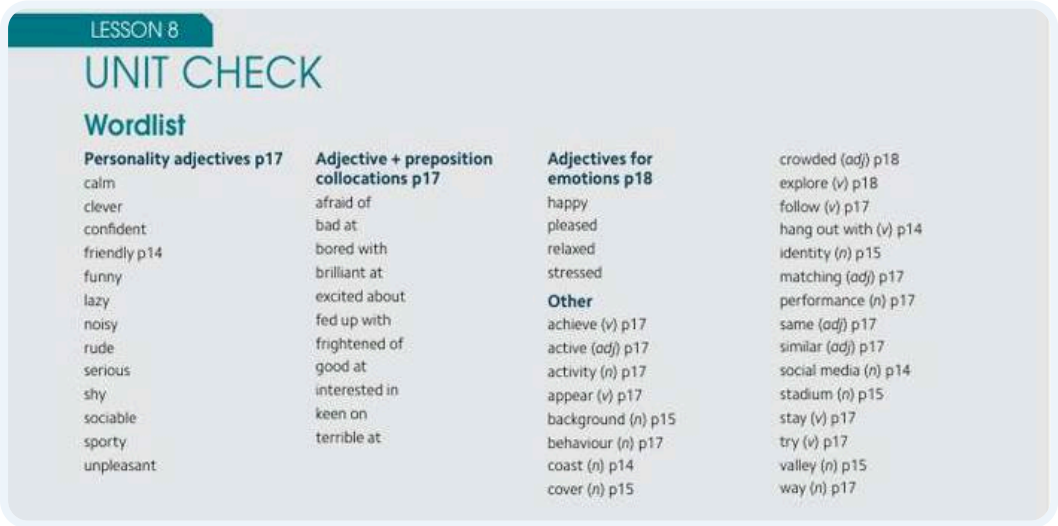
The video

In the video, adults learned new things. A woman learned pottery. A man learned to mend a car. A grandfather learned to use an **app**.

The video said: "Some adults choose evening classes to learn new things. Learning new **skills** can help you feel more **confident** and meet new people. People can learn **anywhere** and at **any age**, with apps and online **tutorials**."

"A tutorial is a lesson that teaches you how to do something," Hamed whispered to Majid.

After the class, one man told Uncle Khalfan, "I got a **promotion** at work because of my new skills!"



LESSON 8

UNIT CHECK

Wordlist

Personality adjectives p17
calm
clever
confident
friendly p14
funny
lazy
noisy
rude
serious
shy
sociable
sporty
unpleasant

Adjective + preposition collocations p17
afraid of
bad at
bored with
brilliant at
excited about
fed up with
frightened of
good at
interested in
keen on
terrible at

Adjectives for emotions p18
happy
pleased
relaxed
stressed

Other
achieve (*v*) p17
active (*adj*) p17
activity (*n*) p17
appear (*v*) p17
background (*n*) p15
behaviour (*n*) p17
coast (*n*) p14
cover (*n*) p15
crowded (*adj*) p18
explore (*v*) p18
follow (*v*) p17
hang out with (*v*) p14
identity (*n*) p15
matching (*adj*) p17
performance (*n*) p17
same (*adj*) p17
similar (*adj*) p17
social media (*n*) p14
stadium (*n*) p15
stay (*v*) p17
try (*v*) p17
valley (*n*) p15
way (*n*) p17

Unit 1 wordlist

❁ ❁ ❁

The project

Back home, Hamed said, "Mr Saif gave us a project. We have to make an **information sheet** for a learning centre."

"Let's make one for my centre," said Uncle Khalfan.

They **arranged** the work. First they decided what classes people can do: car repair, computer skills, Quran recitation, cooking, and first aid. Then they noted what people can learn in each class. Then they gave details: **time, length, what to bring, what they will learn**.

> **Car Repair for Beginners** – Mondays, 7–9 p.m. – 10 weeks. Bring: old clothes.
>
> You will learn: how to change a tyre and check the oil.

Majid added photos and drawings. "People will want to **join**!"

Reviewing Unit 1

On Saturday Mr Saif gave a unit check. Hamed and Majid studied together.

"Present simple or present continuous? I ___ (learn) French at school this year."

"**I am learning** – it's temporary, this year. Not 'I am learn'!"

"Fares ___ (not see) his friends every day."

"**doesn't see**. Not 'doesn't sees'. After doesn't, no -s!"

"Stative verbs: I ___ (not know) her."

"**I don't know** her."

"Asma ___ (think) of travelling to Spain this summer."

"**is thinking** – it means considering."

"Fatima and Raya play volleyball… now and then. The time phrase goes at the end."

❁ ❁ ❁

The new notebook

Uncle Khalfan came in with a small notebook. "In my class, the teacher told us: **write new words in a notebook with the Arabic meaning and an example**."

"Our teacher says that too!" said Hamed. "And use the **wordlist** on page 23 to revise every word in the unit."

Two months later, Uncle Khalfan repaired the family car by himself. He was proud and **confident**. "See?" he said. "Learning is fun – at any age!"

💡 I am learning, not I am learn. She doesn't see, not she doesn't sees.

📖 Words from the story

evening class حصة مسائية	**arrange** يرتّب / ينسّق
repair يصلح	**join** ينضم
confidence الثقة بالنفس	**promotion** ترقية
skill مهارة	**tutorial** درس تعليمي

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ You can keep learning all through your life, at any age
- ✔ Adults choose evening classes to learn things like pottery or mending a car
- ✔ New skills help you feel more confident and meet new people
- ✔ People can learn anywhere with apps and online tutorials
- ✔ An information sheet gives the class, time, length, what to bring and what you will learn
- ✔ Review: present simple vs continuous, stative verbs, adverbs of frequency, personality adjectives
- ✔ Write new words with the Arabic meaning and an example

🤔 Little questions

1. What is an evening class?
   Answer: a class for adults in the evening
2. What does repair mean?
   Answer: fix
3. Which form is right: Fares ___ (not see) his friends every day?
   Answer: doesn't see
4. Complete: I ___ (learn) French at school this year.
   Answer: am learning
5. Correct this: I am learn French.
   Answer: I am learning French.



Lesson 2-1 · Connections: Reading – The importance of languages

The Boy Who Didn't Need French

Travel story Unit 2: Connections

👥 Liam, a Canadian pen pal of Hamed, who tells his own story in a letter

Hamed had a pen pal in **Canada** called Liam. One day Liam sent him a long letter. Hamed read it to Majid.

"Dear Hamed, you asked me why I'm learning Arabic now. Here is my story."

French everywhere

"I grew up in Canada. Canada has two **official languages**: English and French. I saw French on signs, in stores and on TV every day. But when I was young, I felt French **wasn't useful**. I didn't think it was **necessary**. Everyone around me spoke English. Why did I need French?"

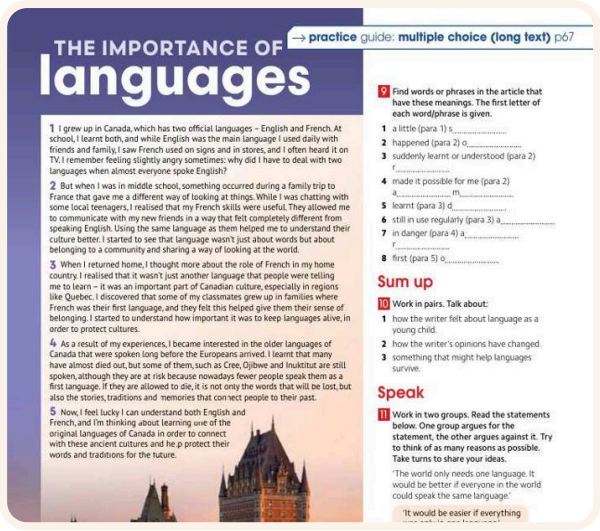
Majid said, "That's like me with English in Grade 4!"

❁ ❁ ❁

The trip that changed everything

"Then, in middle school, my class went on a trip to **France**. On the second day, I was in a small town. I wanted to buy bread, but the baker didn't speak English. I tried my school French: 'Bonjour... du pain, s'il vous plaît.' He smiled and gave me the bread!

"In the afternoon, I met some local teenagers in the park. We chatted in French about football and food. My French skills were **useful to communicate** with them. That day I **realised** something important: **language isn't just about words. It is about culture.** When you speak someone's language, you understand their jokes, their food, their way of life."



THE IMPORTANCE OF languages

→ practice guide: multiple choice (long text) p67

1 I grew up in Canada, which has two official languages – English and French. At school, I learnt both, and while English was the main language I used daily with friends and family, I saw French used on signs and in stores, and I often heard it on TV. I remember feeling slightly angry sometimes: why did I have to deal with two languages when almost everyone spoke English?

2 But when I was in middle school, something occurred during a family trip to France that gave me a different way of looking at things. While I was chatting with some local teenagers, I realised that my French skills were useful. They allowed me to communicate with my new friends in a way that felt completely different from speaking English. Using the same language as them helped me to understand their culture better. I started to see that language wasn't just about words but about belonging to a community and sharing a way of looking at the world.

3 When I returned home, I thought more about the role of French in my home country. I realised that it wasn't just another language that people were telling me to learn – it was an important part of Canadian culture, especially in regions like Quebec. I discovered that some of my classmates grew up in families where French was their first language, and they felt this helped give them their sense of belonging. I started to understand how important it was to keep languages alive, in order to protect cultures.

4 As a result of my experiences, I became interested in the older languages of Canada that were spoken long before the Europeans arrived. I learnt that many have almost died out, but some of them, such as Cree, Ojibwe and Inuktitut are still spoken, although they are at risk because nowadays fewer people speak them as a first language. If they are allowed to die, it is not only the words that will be lost, but also the stories, traditions and memories that connect people to their past.

5 Now, I feel lucky I can understand both English and French, and I'm thinking about learning one of the original languages of Canada in order to connect with these ancient cultures and help protect their words and traditions for the future.

9 Find words or phrases in the article that have these meanings. The first letter of each word/phrase is given.

1 a little (para 1) s_____
2 happened (para 2) o_____
3 suddenly learnt or understood (para 2) r_____
4 made it possible for me (para 2) a_____ m_____
5 learnt (para 3) d_____
6 still in use regularly (para 3) a_____
7 in danger (para 4) a_____ r_____
8 first (para 5) o_____

Sum up

10 Work in pairs. Talk about:

1 how the writer felt about language as a young child.
2 how the writer's opinions have changed.
3 something that might help languages survive.

Speak

11 Work in two groups. Read the statements below. One group argues for the statement, the other argues against it. Try to think of as many reasons as possible. Take turns to share your ideas.

'The world only needs one language. It would be better if everyone in the world could speak the same language.'

'It would be easier if everything

The importance of languages (article)

Languages at risk

"When I came home, my classmates told me stories about their grandparents. Canada has many **original** languages, such as **Cree**, **Ojibwe** and **Inuktitut**. These are very **ancient** languages. But today they are **at risk**. Some young people don't speak them anymore. If nobody speaks a language, it can **die out**: it disappears completely. I want to help **protect** these languages, so that they **survive**. Every language belongs to a **community**."

❁ ❁ ❁

Facts that surprised Hamed

At the end of the letter, Liam wrote some facts:

"Did you know? There are still **over 7,000** spoken languages in the world. Some languages are dying out. Speaking more than one language helps your brain. And **Arabic is spoken by more than 300 million people!** That's why I'm learning Arabic now."

Hamed felt proud. "Arabic is one of the most spoken languages in the world!"

The class discussion

The next day Mr Saif asked the class: "Does the world need only **one language**?"

Majid said: "**For**: It would be easier if everyone spoke the same language. No dictionaries!"

Hamed said: "**Against**: Different languages make the world much more interesting. Liam learned that in France."

Then Mr Saif gave a reading tip. "In the exam, the **last question** often tests your understanding of the **main point** of the whole text. Read the whole text first, then read each question carefully. Find the part of the text that gives the answer. And be careful: don't

choose an answer just because it **repeats words** from the text. The correct answer has the **same meaning**, not the same words."

"So what was the main point of Liam's letter?" asked Majid.

"Language is part of culture, and we must stop languages from dying out," said Hamed.

"Perfect. And before you read, always **look at the title and the photos first** to predict the topic."

That night, Hamed wrote back to Liam – in simple Arabic.

📖 Words from the story

official language لغة رسمية	**die out** ينقرض / يختفي
culture ثقافة	**realise** يُدرك
ancient قديم	**survive** يبقى / ينجو
original أصلي	**at risk** في خطر
protect يحمي	**community** مجتمع

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Canada has two official languages, English and French
- ✔ When he was young the writer didn't think French was necessary
- ✔ A trip to France showed him French was useful to communicate with local teenagers
- ✔ He realised that language is not just about words, it is about culture
- ✔ Original Canadian languages like Cree, Ojibwe and Inuktitut are at risk of dying out
- ✔ There are over 7,000 spoken languages, and Arabic is spoken by more than 300 million people
- ✔ The last question tests the main point, and the right answer has the same meaning, not the same words

🤔 Little questions

1. How many official languages does Canada have?
   Answer: two, English and French

2. How many spoken languages are there in the world?

   Answer: over 7,000

3. What did the writer learn in France?

   Answer: French was useful to communicate with people

4. What does die out mean?

   Answer: to disappear completely

5. How did the writer feel about French when he was young?

   Answer: He didn't think it was necessary



Lesson 2-2 · Grammar: Talking about the past

The Evening Phone Call

Family story · Unit 2: Connections

👥 Hamed, his grandmother (Jaddati Moza), and Majid

Hamed's grandmother didn't understand something. "Why don't you **want** to make phone calls? You only send messages!"

Hamed laughed. "Grandma, how did you talk to your friends when you were young?"

She sat down and began her story.

Grandma's story

"When I was a girl, I **grew up** in a small village. We **had** one telephone in the whole street. Phone calls **were** very **expensive**, so people **chatted** only in the evenings."

"Wait," said Hamed. "These verbs are all in the **past simple**. For **finished actions or situations** in the past. And for **past habits**: people chatted only in the evenings."

"One evening," Grandma continued, "I **was walking** to my grandma's house with a plate of halwa. The sun **was going** down and the birds **were singing**. Suddenly, my friend **called** my name from her window!"

❁ ❁ ❁

Two tenses together

Majid came in and listened. "That's the **past continuous**! **was / were + verb-ing**. For actions **in progress** at a time in the past. At six o'clock Grandma **was walking**."

"And then something short happened: her friend **called**. That's past simple," said Hamed. "A **longer action** is **interrupted** by a **shorter** one."

He wrote in his notebook:

while + long action (past continuous): **While** I **was walking** home, it **started** to rain.

when + short action (past simple): I **was doing** my homework **when** the phone **rang**.



We use the past simple for finished actions or situations in the past, past habits, regular past events or past actions that happened one after the other.

I **grew up** in Canada.
I **started** to see that language wasn't just about words.

past continuous

We use the past continuous to describe actions in progress in the past, especially when another action (past simple) interrupts the first one (past continuous).

While I **was chatting** with some local teenagers, I **realised** that my French skills were useful.

Watch or listen

3 2.01 Watch or listen to people talking about actions in progress. Which of these things do they talk about?

A what they were doing last night
B what they were doing when something else happened
C what they were doing when they met their best friend

4 2.01 What did each speaker say? Complete the sentences with the past simple or past continuous form of the verbs in brackets. Watch or listen again and check your answers.

Explore grammar: talking about the past

Liam's sentence

Hamed showed Majid a sentence from Liam's letter: "**While** I **was chatting** with some local teenagers, I **realised** that my French skills were useful."

"Long action: was chatting. Short action: realised," said Majid. "And look at this: 'I **started** to see that language wasn't just about words.' Actions one after the other – past simple."

❁ ❁ ❁

The verbs that don't continue

Majid tried a sentence: "When I was young, I was knowing all the songs on the radio."

"No!" said Hamed. "Some verbs are **not used in the past continuous**: the **stative verbs**: **know, like, hate, hear, see**. Say: I **knew**. And in Liam's letter: I **saw** French on signs. I **heard** it on TV."

"So: While I was walking to school, I **saw** my friend. Not 'I was seeing'."

"Exactly."

How communication changed

Grandma smiled. "Your father **grew up** with a phone at home, but calls **were** still expensive. He **spent** hours on the phone only on Fridays. Then everything changed."

"Our book says that in **2016**, **communication** changed: it became possible to communicate **quickly and easily**," said Hamed. "Every **generation** communicates in a different way. Now I listen to a **podcast** and chat with Liam in Canada for free!"

Grandma picked up Hamed's phone. "Then call your aunt now. A voice is better than a message."

While Hamed **was calling** his aunt, Grandma **was making** tea. And when his aunt **answered**, everyone **laughed**.

> 💡 when + short action (past simple). while + long action (past continuous). Stative verbs stay in the past simple.

📖 Words from the story

interrupt يقاطع	**in progress** قيد التنفيذ / مستمر
communication تواصل	**generation** جيل
expensive غالي	**podcast** بودكاست
stative حالة	

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ The past simple is for finished actions, past habits and actions one after the other: I grew up in Canada
- ✔ The past continuous is for actions in progress at a time in the past: At six o'clock I was walking
- ✔ Form: was or were + verb-ing
- ✔ A long action in the past continuous can be interrupted by a short action in the past simple
- ✔ while + long action, when + short action
- ✔ Stative verbs like know, like, hate, hear, see are not used in the continuous
- ✔ In the past phone calls were expensive, so people chatted only in the evenings

🤔 Little questions

1. What is the form of the past continuous?
   Answer: was/were + verb-ing
2. Which tense is for an interrupted long action?
   Answer: past continuous
3. What is the past simple of grow?
   Answer: grew
4. Complete: While I ___ (walk) home, it started to rain.
   Answer: was walking

5. Correct this: I was knowing the answer.

Answer: I knew the answer.



Lesson 2-3 · Vocabulary: Language and communication

Lucia's Visit

Friendship story · Unit 2: Connections

👥 Hamed's cousin Noor and her pen pal Lucia from Madrid, told by Hamed

Hamed's cousin Noor had a **pen pal** called Lucia from Madrid. This year, Lucia visited Oman with her family. Hamed and his family **met** them at the airport.

"Hola! Marhaba!" said Lucia. Then nobody knew what to say!

Problems at the start

At first Noor and Lucia **didn't understand** each other well. Noor's English was good, but Lucia spoke fast. Noor said, "Can you **repeat** that, please?"

Lucia tried to **explain** something about Spanish food, but Noor didn't know what one word **meant**.

"What does 'tortilla' **mean**?" she asked.

"It's a kind of egg dish with potatoes."

Then Lucia tried to say "khanjar". "How do you **pronounce** it?"

"Khan-jar," said Noor. "You don't always know how to pronounce a word from the way it's written – in English too!"

❁ ❁ ❁

Technology helps

"Let's use an **app**," said Noor. She typed a sentence, and the app **translated** it into Spanish. But sometimes the translation was funny.

"I find the AI on my phone doesn't always **translate** words correctly," Noor laughed.

"If I don't know what a word means, I **look it up** in my dictionary," said Lucia.

They **communicated** with words, pictures, gestures – and lots of laughing. They laughed a lot and got closer. In the end, **language differences didn't matter**.



Explore language: verb + preposition collocations

Hamed's mistakes

At dinner, Hamed wanted to practise his English. "Lucia, can you say me about Madrid?"

His father smiled. "Hamed, we **say** something **to** someone, but we **tell** someone something. So: Can you **tell me** about Madrid?"

"Oh! Tell me about Madrid, please."

Lucia **told** them a story about her city. Then she asked, "What were you **talking about** before I came?"

"We were **talking about** football," said Hamed. "And who were you **talking to** on the phone?"

"I was **speaking to** my mother. I **explained to** her the meaning of 'marhaba'."

❁ ❁ ❁

Tell, talk, say, speak, hear, listen

After dinner, Noor made **cards** to help Hamed: the verb on one side, the preposition on the other.

listen to, **talk to**, **speak to**, **explain (something) to** someone.

talk about, **speak about**.

Then she wrote three pairs:

Tell us a story. / **Talk** to me if you have a problem.

Say the alphabet in English. / We **speak** two languages at home.

Hear = sounds come to your ears. / **Listen to** = pay attention.

"Remember," said Noor. "**tell** + person: tell me. **say** + words: say hello."

"And never 'You never listen me'," laughed Lucia. "**You never listen to me!**"

The goodbye

On the last day, Lucia's car was leaving. It was very noisy.

"I can't **hear** you!" shouted Noor. "Please speak louder!"

Lucia shouted back, "I'll write to you! And next time, I'll **speak** Arabic!"

Hamed waved. He understood now: to **communicate**, you need more than words. You need a friend who wants to understand you.

> 💡 She told me the answer, not she said me. Listen to me, not listen me.

📖 Words from the story

explain يشرح	**mean** يعني
pronounce ينطق	**repeat** يكرر
translate يترجم	**understand** يفهم
pen pal صديق مراسلة	**app** تطبيق
communicate يتواصل	

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Communication verbs: explain, mean, pronounce, repeat, translate, understand
- ✔ If you don't know what a word means, look it up
- ✔ Verb + preposition: listen to, talk to, speak to, explain something to someone, talk about
- ✔ We say something to someone, but tell someone something
- ✔ tell + person (tell me), say + words (say hello)
- ✔ We speak languages: We speak two languages at home
- ✔ Hear means sounds come to your ears, listen to means pay attention

🤔 Little questions

1. Which preposition comes after listen?
   Answer: to

2. Which verb do we use with languages, say or speak?

   Answer: speak

3. What does translate mean?

   Answer: change words into another language

4. Correct this: She said me the answer.

   Answer: She told me the answer.

5. Choose: I can't ___ you. Please speak louder. (hear / listen)

   Answer: hear



Lesson 2-4 · Listening & Speaking: Communicating with animals and describing a photo

The Horse Whisperer's Secret

Documentary story | Unit 2: Connections

👥 Hamed and Majid watching a nature talk, then doing a speaking test

In the school hall, a scientist gave a talk: **How humans and animals communicate**.

Before the talk, Mr Saif gave the boys a worksheet with gaps. "**Read the sentences before you listen**," he said. "**Predict** the kind of word missing: a place, a number, a thing? Then write **one or two words or a number**."

Hamed read: "In the USA, Monty Roberts watched the way ___ behaved." He wrote "animal?" in pencil.

The talk

The scientist began: "In the **USA**, a man called **Monty Roberts** watched the way **horses behaved**. He noticed how they **communicate** with their bodies. **Copying** this allowed Monty to communicate with young horses."

Hamed changed his answer: **horses**.

"In **Brazil**, **dolphins** chase fish towards the fishermen. The fishermen and the dolphins work together!"

"Experts in some **African countries** use **sounds** to keep **elephants** away from villages."

"And **scientists** hope **AI** can help us understand animal sounds, like the **sperm whale's alphabet**."

Majid whispered, "Whales have an alphabet?"

"Maybe!" said Hamed.

❁ ❁ ❁

The -ing form

After the talk, Mr Saif pointed to two sentences.

"**Copying** this allowed Monty to communicate with young horses." – "The **-ing form** is the **subject** of the sentence."

"Many cases rely on **treating** the animals with respect." – "Here it comes **after a preposition**: on treating."

"So I can't say 'Learn a language is fun'?" asked Majid.

"No. **Learning** a language is fun. And not 'She is good at draw'. She is good at **drawing**."



Explore language: describing a photo

The speaking test

The next day, the boys had a speaking test. Each boy had to **describe a photo** for **about one minute**.

Hamed got a photo of a family in a living room. He remembered the plan: **introduce → describe the place → the people → what they are doing**.

"I think this photo shows a typical **scene** in a family home," he began. "You can see that this photo was taken in a **living room** because there is a sofa and a TV. There are **four people** in this photo. There's a grandfather, a father and two boys. They **might** be watching a football match, because they look excited. The grandfather is laughing. I think they are happy to be together."

Mr Saif nodded. "Good use of **might**. Use it when you are **not sure**: They might be friends."

❁ ❁ ❁

Majid's turn

Majid got a photo of people on a **bus**. He was nervous, but he took a breath.

"I think this photo shows people travelling in a city. You can see that this photo was taken **on a bus** because there are seats and windows. There are three people, and they are **chatting** to each other. They might be going to work, or they **might** be students. One man is reading. The scene is busy but calm."

"Excellent!" said Mr Saif. "You both spoke for one minute and described the place, the people and the actions."

On the way home, Majid saw a cat on a wall. "Hello, cat," he said. "**Understanding** animals is difficult. But **describing** them is easy now!"

> 💡 -ing form as subject: Learning is fun. After prepositions: good at drawing.

📖 Words from the story

communicate يتواصل	**behave** يتصرف
scientist عالِم	**sound** صوت
whale حوت	**dolphin** دلفين
horse حصان	**describe** يصف
scene مشهد	

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Monty Roberts in the USA watched how horses behaved and copied it to communicate with young horses
- ✔ In Brazil dolphins chase fish towards fishermen, and in Africa sounds keep elephants away
- ✔ Scientists hope AI can help us understand animal sounds like the sperm whale's alphabet
- ✔ The -ing form can be the subject: Copying this allowed Monty to communicate
- ✔ The -ing form comes after prepositions: rely on treating, good at drawing
- ✔ In sentence completion, read first, predict the type of word, write one or two words or a number
- ✔ Describe a photo for one minute: introduction, place, people, actions, and use might when not sure

🤔 Little questions

1. Where do we use the -ing form?
   Answer: as a subject and after prepositions
2. How long do you speak about a photo?
   Answer: about one minute
3. Who watched how horses behaved?
   Answer: Monty Roberts

4. Complete: ___ (learn) a new language is fun.

   Answer: Learning

5. Correct this: She is good at draw.

   Answer: She is good at drawing.



Lesson 2-5 · Writing: A story

The Photo on Jebel Shams

Adventure story · Unit 2: Connections

👥 Hamed, Majid and Hamed's father on a trip to Jebel Shams

Mr Saif gave the class a writing task:

> "Write a story of about **100 words**. Your story must begin with this sentence: **I looked around and thought: 'I have to take a photo and show it to my friends.'**"

"First think of an **idea** that could follow the sentence," said Mr Saif. "Then **plan** it: **When? Where? Who? What happened in the end?** And plan the **tenses** you can use."

Hamed's plan

Hamed remembered a real trip. He wrote his plan:

When? Last winter, early morning. Where? Jebel Shams, the highest mountain in Oman. Who? Me, Majid and my father. What happened? We saw the sun rise over the canyon, and a family of wild goats. In the end? We were late for breakfast, but we were happy.

"Tenses," he thought. "**Past continuous** for the **background**: It was raining, the wind was blowing. **Past simple** for the **events**: Suddenly I saw..."

❁ ❁ ❁

Strong adjectives

Mr Saif showed a list of **strong adjectives**: **awful, brilliant, delicious, disgusting, fantastic, hilarious, huge, miserable, terrible, wonderful**.

"We use them to make writing **more interesting**," he said. "Not 'The canyon was really big'. Say: The canyon was **huge**!"

"And very funny?" asked Majid.

"**Hilarious**. Very bad? **Terrible** or **awful**. Very good? **Brilliant**, **fantastic**, **wonderful**. Very sad? **Miserable**."



8 Read the language box. Then find strong adjectives and adverbs in the story in Ex 7.

explore **language**

strong adjectives and adverbs

We use strong adjectives to make our writing more interesting.

awful brilliant delicious disgusting fantastic
hilarious huge miserable terrible wonderful

We can also use an adverb to make an adjective stronger.

really good very exciting extremely dangerous

We don't use *very* or *extremely* with strong adjectives. We use *absolutely*.

~~very fantastic~~ absolutely fantastic
~~extremely brilliant~~ absolutely brilliant

9 Find words in the sentences that can be replaced with these adjectives.

Explore language: strong adjectives and adverbs

"Now, adverbs," said Mr Saif. "We can use an adverb to make a normal adjective stronger: **really** good, **very** exciting, **extremely** dangerous. But with **strong adjectives**, we don't use very or extremely. We use **absolutely**."

He wrote: × very fantastic ✓ **absolutely fantastic**. × extremely brilliant ✓ **absolutely brilliant**. × very delicious ✓ **absolutely delicious**.

Hamed's story

Hamed wrote:

> "I looked around and thought: 'I have to take a photo and show it to my friends.' It was six o'clock in the morning on Jebel Shams. The cold wind **was blowing** and my father **was making** tea. Majid **was sleeping** in the car! Suddenly, the sun **came up** over the **huge** canyon. The colours were **absolutely wonderful**. Then I **saw** a family of wild goats on the rocks. I **took** ten photos. Majid **woke up** and **missed** everything – it was **hilarious**! We **were** late for breakfast, but I **felt** absolutely happy."

❁ ❁ ❁

Improving the story

Hamed gave his story to Majid. "Check it. I wrote 98 words."

Majid read it. "You used the past continuous for the background and the past simple for the events. Good. You used strong adjectives: huge, wonderful, hilarious. And you **ended with how you felt**. But... I wasn't sleeping!"

"Yes, you were," laughed Hamed.

Mr Saif read the stories the next day. "Some students wrote the **whole story in the present tense**. That's a common mistake. A story about the past needs **past tenses**. Hamed, your story is absolutely brilliant."

Majid smiled. "And I'm absolutely miserable – because I missed the goats!"

> 💡 Strong adjectives go with absolutely, not very: absolutely fantastic.

📖 Words from the story

awful فظيع	**brilliant** رائع
delicious لذيذ	**disgusting** مقرف
fantastic رائع	**hilarious** مضحك جدًا
huge ضخم	**miserable** تعيس
terrible سيئ جدًا	**wonderful** رائع

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ A story is about 100 words and must start with the given sentence
- ✔ Plan: When? Where? Who? What happened in the end?
- ✔ Use the past continuous for the background and the past simple for the events
- ✔ Strong adjectives: awful, brilliant, delicious, disgusting, fantastic, hilarious, huge, miserable, terrible, wonderful
- ✔ Make normal adjectives stronger with really, very, extremely
- ✔ With strong adjectives use absolutely, not very or extremely
- ✔ End your story with how you felt, and don't write it in the present tense

🤔 Little questions

1. Which adverb goes with strong adjectives?
   Answer: absolutely
2. What is a strong adjective for very funny?
   Answer: hilarious

3. What is a strong adjective for very big?
   Answer: huge
4. Correct this: The film was very fantastic.
   Answer: The film was absolutely fantastic.
5. Which tense do we use for the background of a story?
   Answer: past continuous



Lesson 2-6 · Switch on & Unit check: You and your phone

A Week Without a Phone

Challenge story Unit 2: Connections

👥 Hamed and Majid, who try a week without phones

Mr Saif showed a video. Teenagers spoke about living **one week without a phone**.

"How much time do you spend on your phone each day?" he asked the class.

Majid looked at his phone. "Four hours..."

"Then I have a challenge for you," said Mr Saif. "One week. No phone. Then tell us the **advantages** and **disadvantages**."

Day 1: Problems

On Sunday, Majid wanted to meet Hamed at the football field. But how? He couldn't send a message. He walked to Hamed's house and knocked on the door.

"This is difficult," said Majid. "It's hard to **contact** people. Making an **arrangement** to meet friends takes a long time."

In the video, the teenagers said the same things: the **difficulty of contacting people** and **agreeing to meet friends**.

❁ ❁ ❁

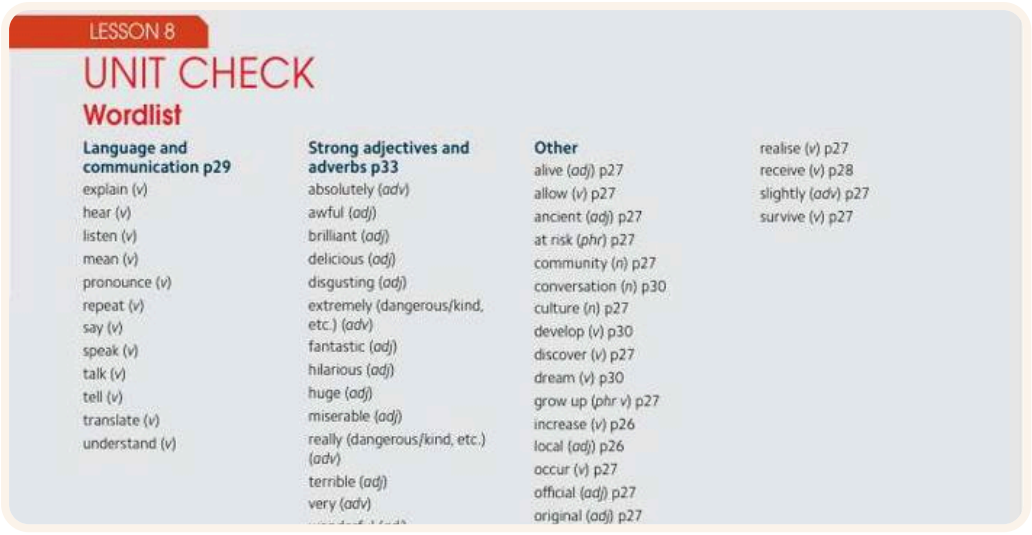
Day 4: Something changes

By Wednesday, something strange happened. Majid finished his homework **assignment** early. He read a book. He played football for two hours.

"I feel **less busy**," he told Hamed. "I'm **offline**, and my head is quiet."

"In the video, one boy said he **enjoyed outdoor activities** more," said Hamed.

"Life without a phone **could be different, but not impossible**."



LESSON 8

UNIT CHECK

Wordlist

Language and communication p29

explain (v)
hear (v)
listen (v)
mean (v)
pronounce (v)
repeat (v)
say (v)
speak (v)
talk (v)
tell (v)
translate (v)
understand (v)

Strong adjectives and adverbs p33

absolutely (adv)
awful (adj)
brilliant (adj)
delicious (adj)
disgusting (adj)
extremely (dangerous/kind, etc.) (adv)
fantastic (adj)
hilarious (adj)
huge (adj)
miserable (adj)
really (dangerous/kind, etc.) (adv)
terrible (adj)
very (adv)

Other

alive (adj) p27
allow (v) p27
ancient (adj) p27
at risk (phr) p27
community (n) p27
conversation (n) p30
culture (n) p27
develop (v) p30
discover (v) p27
dream (v) p30
grow up (phr v) p27
increase (v) p26
local (adj) p26
occur (v) p27
official (adj) p27
original (adj) p27
realise (v) p27
receive (v) p28
slightly (adv) p27
survive (v) p27

Unit 2 wordlist

I'd or I'll?

In class, they practised listening to natural speech. Mr Saif played a recording: "**I'd** like to try it again." and "**I'll** call you tomorrow."

"They sound similar!" said Majid.

"**I'd** = **I would**. **I'll** = **I will**," said Mr Saif. "Listen to the end of the word. Don't confuse them."

"I'd like my phone back," said Majid. "And I'll use it less!"

❁ ❁ ❁

The project: life before mobile phones

For their **project**, the boys interviewed Hamed's father about a typical day in the **1980s**.

"How did you **chat to friends**?"

"We visited them, or used the home phone in the evening."

"How did you **find out what time a shop opened**?"

"We asked people, or we went there!"

"How did you **buy tickets**?"

"At the ticket office. We waited in a line."

"How did you find a **holiday destination**?"

"From books, maps and friends' stories."

The boys made a short presentation. Hamed gave his **opinion**: "Some things were **better then**: people met face to face. Some things are **better now**: we can **keep in touch** with family far away."

The unit check

On the last day, the boys reviewed Unit 2.

"While I **was walking** in the park, I **realised** my brother was trying to tell me something. Long action and short action."

"When my dad grew up, he **spent** hours talking on the phone. Not 'was spending' – it's a finished habit."

"State or action? **believe, hate, like, want** are **state** verbs. **decide, look forward to, stop, watch** are **action** verbs. So never 'I was knowing him' – say **I knew him**."

Mr Saif also told them about '**false friends**': "A false friend is a word in a foreign language that is similar to one in your own, but **doesn't mean the same thing**."

"Like 'actually' – it doesn't mean 'now'!" said Hamed.

Majid got his phone back. He looked at it, then put it in his bag. "Let's play football first," he said.

> 💡 I'd = I would. I'll = I will. Revise with the wordlist on page 35.

📖 Words from the story

advantage ميزة	**disadvantage** عيب
keep in touch يبقى على تواصل	**arrangement** ترتيب
offline غير متصل بالإنترنت	**assignment** واجب / مهمة
communicate يتواصل	

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Without a phone it is hard to contact people and arrange to meet friends
- ✔ But you can feel less busy and enjoy outdoor activities, so life without a phone is different but not impossible
- ✔ I'd means I would and I'll means I will
- ✔ The project compares a typical day in the 1980s with today
- ✔ Past simple vs past continuous: While I was walking, I realised...
- ✔ State verbs: believe, hate, like, want. Action verbs: decide, look forward to, stop, watch
- ✔ A false friend is a foreign word similar to one in your language with a different meaning

🤔 Little questions

1. What does I'd mean?
   Answer: I would
2. What does I'll mean?
   Answer: I will
3. Is like a state or an action verb?
   Answer: state
4. Choose: When my dad grew up, he ___ (spent / was spending) hours on the phone.
   Answer: spent
5. What is a false friend?
   Answer: a foreign word that looks like a word in your language but has a different meaning

The Film That Knew Majid

Science fiction story Unit 3: The future is now

👥 Majid, his smart TV called "Nova", and Hamed

Majid switched on his new smart TV. A friendly voice said: "Good evening, Majid. My name is Nova. Last week you watched three football films and one film about the desert. I **recommend** this new film about a camel race. I think you will like it."

"How do you know?" asked Majid.

"I use **Artificial Intelligence (AI)**. I study your **preferences** – the things you like more than others."

AI is transforming entertainment

Hamed came in. "Our reading text in class was about this! **AI is transforming the world of entertainment.** Transform means **change something completely**. **Online platforms** use AI to recommend films we might like."

"What's a **platform**?" asked Majid.

"A website or app where you watch or share things."

Nova spoke again. "Would you like to choose the ending of the film? There are two **versions**: a happy ending and a surprise ending."

"I can choose the ending?"

"Yes," said Hamed. "Some online movie services let viewers **choose between different endings**. It's **interactive** entertainment. You are part of the story."



The future of entertainment (article)

❁ ❁ ❁

Virtual stars

After the film, Majid looked at his social media. "Look at this famous character. He has two million followers!"

Hamed laughed. "He isn't real. He's a **virtual** character – made by computers. **Virtual characters on social media are created with AI.**"

"And next year I'll see a concert with a **hologram**?"

"Maybe. A hologram is a 3D image that looks real. And the text says: **Soon you'll be able to produce films with simple tools.** Produce means make something."

"So I can make my own film?"

"You can. AI will help you."

The challenges

Majid looked worried. "If AI can do everything, will actors lose their jobs?"

"That's one of the **challenges**," said Hamed. "**Some people worry that AI could replace human jobs in entertainment.** But the text also says **we will still need actors, because AI cannot create everything.** The key is the ability of humans to **work creatively with AI**. People must stay **creative**."

"So AI is not always good?"

"No. It brings exciting changes, but there are problems too."

❁ ❁ ❁

Reading like a detective

The next day, Mr Saif gave the class a **gapped text**: some sentences were missing.

"First, **skim** the text – read it quickly to understand what it is about," he said. "Move your eyes across the text to pick out **key words**. Read the **first one or two lines** of each paragraph. Then for each gap, check the sentences **before and after** it."

"What's the difference between skim and scan?" asked Majid.

"**Skim** = read quickly for the **general idea**. **Scan** = look for **specific information**, like a number."

Majid scanned the text. "Here's a number: **animated films** have a **30 percent higher profit margin** than those with real actors!"

"And a warning," said Mr Saif. "Don't fill a gap with a sentence just because it has the **same words**. Check that the **ideas** before and after the gap fit."

That evening Nova said, "Majid, I recommend..."

"Thank you, Nova," said Majid. "But tonight I'm choosing myself. And I'm making my own film – with my own ideas!"

> 💡 Skim for the general idea. Scan for specific information. Check before and after each gap.

📖 Words from the story

artificial intelligence (AI) الذكاء الاصطناعي	**transform** يُغيّر جذريًا
recommend يوصي / يقترح	**virtual** افتراضي
interactive تفاعلي	**hologram** صورة ثلاثية الأبعاد
platform منصة	**challenge** تحدٍّ
creative مبدع	**preference** تفضيل

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ AI is transforming entertainment: online platforms use AI to recommend films
- ✔ Some movie services let viewers choose between different endings
- ✔ Virtual characters on social media are created with AI, and soon anyone can produce films
- ✔ Challenge: people worry AI could replace human jobs, but we will still need actors
- ✔ The key is humans working creatively with AI
- ✔ In a gapped text, skim first, read the first lines of each paragraph, and check before and after each gap
- ✔ Skim means read quickly for the general idea, scan means look for specific information

🤔 Little questions

1. What does AI stand for?
   Answer: Artificial Intelligence
2. What does virtual mean?
   Answer: not real, made by computers

3. Name one challenge of AI.

   Answer: It could replace human jobs

4. What does recommend mean?

   Answer: to suggest something that someone might like

5. What is the difference between skim and scan?

   Answer: skim is for the general idea, scan is for specific information



Lesson 3-2 · Grammar: Talking about the future

Four Ways to Tomorrow

Weekend plan story Unit 3: The future is now

👥 Hamed, Majid, and Hamed's older brother Saud

It was Thursday evening. Hamed, Majid and Hamed's brother Saud were talking about the weekend.

"English has **four ways** to talk about the future," said Saud, who was at university. "Let's use all of them tonight."

will

Majid looked at the sky. "I think it **will be** a nice weekend."

"That's **will** for a **prediction based on your opinion**," said Saud. "Like: I think the way a book is written **will change** in the future."

Suddenly the lights went off. "It's dark in here. **I'll turn** the light on," said Hamed, and he found the switch.

"Also **will**," said Saud. "For **immediate decisions** – you decided just now."

"I forgot my money for the cinema!" said Majid.

"Don't worry, **I'll lend** you some money," said Saud. "**will** for **offers** too."

❁ ❁ ❁

be going to

"What are your plans for the holiday?" asked Saud.

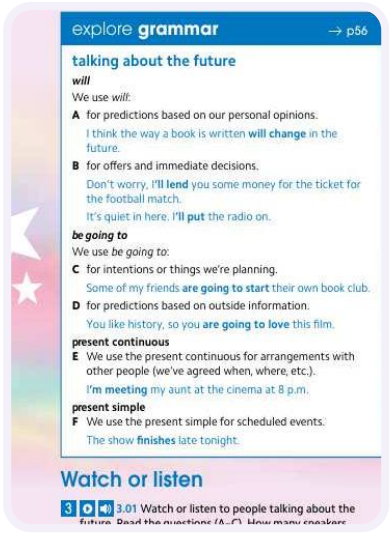
"Some of my friends **are going to start** their own book club," said Hamed. "And I'm **going to join** it."

"That's **be going to** for **intentions and plans**. You decided before now."

Majid pointed out of the window. "Look at those black clouds! It **is going to rain**."

"Also **be going to**: a prediction based on **evidence** – what we can see now. Not your opinion – the clouds are the **evidence**."

"And Hamed, you like history," said Saud, "so you **are going to love** this film."



explore **grammar** → p56

talking about the future

will

We use *will*:

A for predictions based on our personal opinions.

I think the way a book is written **will change** in the future.

B for offers and immediate decisions.

Don't worry, I'**ll lend** you some money for the ticket for the football match.

It's quiet in here. I'**ll put** the radio on.

be going to

We use *be going to*:

C for intentions or things we're planning.

Some of my friends **are going to start** their own book club.

D for predictions based on outside information.

You like history, so you **are going to love** this film.

present continuous

E We use the present continuous for arrangements with other people (we've agreed when, where, etc.).

I'**m meeting** my aunt at the cinema at 8 p.m.

present simple

F We use the present simple for scheduled events.

The show **finishes** late tonight.

Watch or listen

3 3.01 Watch or listen to people talking about the

Explore grammar: talking about the future

Present continuous

"I can't come on Saturday," said Majid. "**I'm meeting** my aunt at the cinema at 8 p.m."

"That's the **present continuous** for **arrangements with other people**," said Saud. "There's a time, a place and another person. Don't say 'I will meet my aunt at 8' for an arrangement."

❁ ❁ ❁

Present simple

Hamed checked the cinema website. "The show **starts** at 8 and **finishes** late tonight. And the last bus **leaves** at 11."

"And the **present simple** for **scheduled events and timetables**," said Saud. "Not 'The bus will leave at 11 according to the timetable'. Say: The bus **leaves** at 11."

The hologram comedian

Saud showed them a news story on his phone. "Listen: On Friday, a comedian **starts** a tour of Japan."

"Present simple – it's a timetable!" said Majid.

"People think the hologram world of entertainment **is going to change**."

"Going to – based on what we know now."

"Will we see plays with hologram actors? Some believe there **will always be** a role for real people."

"Will – a prediction and an opinion!" said Hamed.

❁ ❁ ❁

The four questions

Saud wrote four questions on a paper:

Is it a **plan**? → going to.

Is it an **arrangement** with time and place? → present continuous.

Is it a **timetable**? → present simple.

Is it a **quick decision or opinion**? → will.

"Ask yourself these questions every time," he said.

At that moment Hamed's mother called: "Who wants tea?"

"**I'll make** it!" said all three boys together.

Saud laughed. "Quick decision. Perfect use of **will**!"

📖 Words from the story

prediction توقع	**intention** نية
arrangement موعد مرتب	**schedule** جدول
evidence دليل	**offer** عرض
decision قرار	

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ will is for predictions based on opinion: I think it will change
- ✔ will is also for offers and immediate decisions: I'll turn the light on
- ✔ be going to is for intentions and plans: They are going to start a book club
- ✔ be going to is also for predictions from evidence: Look at those clouds, it's going to rain
- ✔ The present continuous is for arrangements with other people: I'm meeting my aunt at 8
- ✔ The present simple is for timetables: The show finishes late
- ✔ Ask: plan, arrangement, timetable or quick decision?

🤔 Little questions

1. Which form do we use for a timetable?
   Answer: present simple

2. Which form do we use for a quick decision?
   Answer: will
3. Which form do we use for a plan?
   Answer: be going to
4. Complete: Look at those clouds! It ___ (rain).
   Answer: is going to rain
5. Correct this for an arrangement: I will meet my friend tomorrow at 5.
   Answer: I'm meeting my friend tomorrow at 5.

Lesson 3-3 · Vocabulary: Technology in the home

The House That Talked Back

Funny story Unit 3: The future is now

👥 Majid's family and their new smart home system, "Bait"

Majid's family moved into a new **smart home**. On the first day, his father **set up** the system – he made it ready to use. "From now on, the house will listen to us. Its name is Bait."

Majid was excited. "Bait, **switch on** the **air conditioning**!"

"Switching on the air conditioning," said Bait. Cold air came into the room.

The machines

Majid walked around the house. In the kitchen there was a **fridge-freezer**, a **dishwasher**, a **microwave** and a **kettle**. Near the bathroom there was a **washing machine**.

"Machines like fridges, freezers, dishwashers and washing machines are called **white goods** in English," said his father.

"Bait, can you **switch on** the dishwasher?"

"The dishwasher is on."

"Bait, **turn up** the music!"

"Turning up the music." The music got louder.

"Too loud! **Turn** it **down**!"

"Turning it down." The music got quieter.


explore **language**

phrasal verbs

Some phrasal verbs can be separated.

Turn on the light. **Turn** the light **on**.

When we use a pronoun, it must come between the verb and particle.

Plug it in first. **Turn it up** now.

Some phrasal verbs cannot be separated.

The lights just **went off** for no reason.

4 Read the language box. Which phrasal verbs in Ex 3 can

Explore language: phrasal verbs

❁ ❁ ❁

Phrasal verbs everywhere

Hamed came to visit. "Your house speaks **phrasal verbs**!" he laughed. He wrote them in his notebook:

switch / turn on = start a light or machine.

switch / turn off = stop it working.

turn up / down = make the sound louder / quieter.

plug in = connect equipment to electricity.

set up = make something ready to use.

go off = stop working.

come on = start working.

"Learn them with an action," he said. "**Turn up** ↑ louder. **Turn down** ↓ quieter."

Where does it go?

Majid wanted to charge the robot vacuum cleaner. "Hamed, plug in it."

"No, no. With a **pronoun**, it must come **between the verb and the particle**: **Plug it in**. **Turn it up**. **Turn it on**."

"But with a noun?"

"Both are OK: **Turn the light on** or **Turn on the light**. These phrasal verbs **can be separated**."

"And all of them?"

"No. Some **cannot be separated**. Listen."

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The problem

At that moment, all the lights **went off**! The air conditioning stopped. The music stopped.

"Bait? Bait!" Nobody answered.

"The lights just **went off** for no reason," said Majid. "Not 'went it off' – **go off** cannot be separated."

They waited in the dark. Then, after one minute, the lights **came on** again. Bait's voice said: "Sorry. The electricity went off. Everything is working again."

Majid's father smiled. "**Smart homes have arrived.** We can control the air conditioning and lights from our phone. In the future, **machines will learn to recognise us and do things for us automatically**."

Bait's advice

Before bed, Majid said, "Bait, leave the light on in the kitchen."

"Majid," said Bait, "there is nobody in the kitchen. **Save electricity: switch off lights when you leave a room.** Shall I switch it off?"

Majid laughed. "Yes, Bait. **Switch it off**."

> 💡 With a pronoun: plug it in, turn it on. go off cannot be separated.

📖 Words from the story

air conditioning تكييف	**dishwasher** غسالة صحون
fridge-freezer ثلاجة بمجمد	**kettle** غلاية
microwave ميكروويف	**washing machine** غسالة ملابس
switch on يشغّل	**turn down** يخفض
plug in يوصل بالكهرباء	**set up** يجهّز / يُعدّ

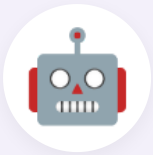
🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Household devices: air conditioning, dishwasher, fridge-freezer, kettle, microwave, washing machine
- ✔ White goods are big machines like fridges, dishwashers and washing machines
- ✔ switch on or off, turn up or down, plug in, set up, go off, come on
- ✔ With a noun some phrasal verbs can be separated: Turn the light on
- ✔ With a pronoun it must go between verb and particle: Plug it in
- ✔ Some cannot be separated: The lights went off
- ✔ In smart homes we control devices from our phone, and machines will learn to recognise us

🤔 Little questions

1. What does plug in mean?
   Answer: connect to electricity
2. What is the opposite of turn up?
   Answer: turn down

3. Where does a pronoun go with a phrasal verb?
   Answer: between the verb and the particle
4. Correct this: Turn on it.
   Answer: Turn it on.
5. Rewrite: Can you start the dishwasher?
   Answer: Can you switch on the dishwasher?



Lesson 3-4 · Listening & Speaking: Technology, advice and opinions

Should Grandpa Buy a Robot?

Family discussion story | Unit 3: The future is now

👥 Hamed, Majid and Hamed's grandfather

Hamed's grandfather had a problem. "My phone is old. My hands get tired when I clean the house. My eyes are tired from small screens. What **should** I buy?"

Hamed and Majid sat down with him. "Let's give you some **advice**," said Hamed.

Advice

"You **should** get a **tablet**, Grandpa," said Hamed. "The screen is bigger."

"And you **ought to** read the **reviews** first," said Majid. "People write what they think about each tablet."

Hamed wrote in his notebook: **should + infinitive**: You should get... **ought to + infinitive**: You ought to look... "Remember: **no 'to' after should**. Not 'You should to buy it'. But **ought** needs **to**."

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Suggestions

"**Why don't you** buy a robot vacuum cleaner?" said Majid. "It does the **household chores** for you."

"**How about getting** an AI **assistant**?" said Hamed. "You can talk to it."

"**We could** go to the shop together on Saturday," said Majid.

"**Shall I** ask my brother Saud? He knows about technology," said Hamed.

"**Shall we** go for pizza after the shop?" said Majid.

Grandpa laughed. "So many suggestions!"



Explore grammar: advice and suggestions

Hamed made a list:

Why don't you / we + infinitive: Why don't you get a tablet?

How about + noun / -ing: How about making a toasted sandwich?

We could + infinitive: We could make an omelette.

Shall I / we: offers and suggestions.

"Not 'How about go to the park?' Say: **How about going** to the park?"

Listening to the shop assistant

In the shop, the **assistant** described three robots. Before he spoke, Hamed looked at the pictures on the brochure. "Our study tip: **predict** before a picture multiple-choice task. Look at the pictures and think: what's different?"

The assistant said, "This robot cleans the floor. This one can talk and remind you about medicine. And this one only plays music."

"The second one!" said Hamed.

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Opinions: agreeing and disagreeing

At home they had a discussion: Are **AI robots** good for older people?

"**I think that** robots can help," said Majid. "They can remind Grandpa about his medicine."

"**What do you think**, Hamed?"

"**I agree**. **That's right.** But I also think people need people."

Grandpa said: "**I don't agree** that a robot is a friend. **OK, but** it can clean the floor!"

Hamed remembered the speaking tip: "In a **collaborative task**, **listen carefully** to your partner and **respond** before you give your own ideas. And use **different phrases** for opinions."

"Did you know," said Majid, "the **first industrial robot** was created in the **1950s**, and it was called **Unimate**?"

The decision

In the end, Grandpa bought the tablet and the robot vacuum cleaner. One evening Hamed called him. "Grandpa, is the robot working?"

"Yes. It cleans everything. But it doesn't drink coffee with me. So **you should** visit me more often!"

"I will, Grandpa. **How about** this Friday?"

> 💡 should + verb (no to). ought to + verb. How about + -ing. Why don't you + verb.

📖 Words from the story

advice نصيحة	**suggestion** اقتراح
tablet جهاز لوحي	**review** مراجعة / تقييم
robot روبوت	**assistant** مساعد
household منزلي	**chore** عمل منزلي

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Advice: should or ought to + infinitive: You should get a tablet
- ✔ There is no to after should, but ought needs to
- ✔ Suggestions: Why don't you + verb, How about + -ing, We could + verb
- ✔ Offers and suggestions with Shall I and Shall we
- ✔ Opinions: I think that, What do you think?, I agree, That's right, I don't agree, OK but
- ✔ In a collaborative task, listen to your partner and respond before giving your ideas
- ✔ The first industrial robot, Unimate, was made in the 1950s

🤔 Little questions

1. Which verb form comes after How about?
   Answer: -ing
2. Do we use to after should?
   Answer: no
3. Give a phrase for disagreeing.
   Answer: I don't agree
4. Correct this: You should to buy it.
   Answer: You should buy it.
5. Give advice: I'm always tired.
   Answer: You should go to bed earlier.

Lesson 3-5 · Writing: An email giving advice

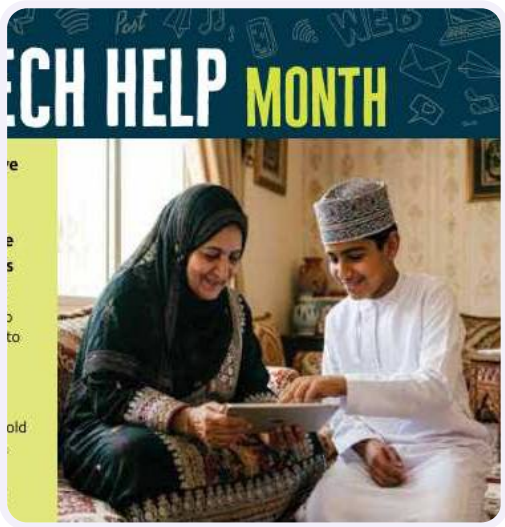
Teen Tech Help Month

Community story · Unit 3: The future is now

👥 Hamed, his friend Khalid who was ill, and the Teen Tech Help team

A notice appeared on the school board:

> **Teen Tech Help Month!** Teenagers often have better technology skills than adults. Help your **community**! Ideas: organise **workshops** to teach basic tech skills to older adults, offer to help a **local business** go digital, plan events to collect old devices and take them for **recycling**.



Notice: Teen Tech Help Month

Hamed's friend Khalid was ill at home that week. He sent Hamed an email:

> "Hi Hamed, I'm sick and I missed the meeting. Which project should I choose? I can't decide. What are you going to do?"

The model email

Mr Saif showed the class a model. Arwa had sent a similar email, and Jood wrote a **reply**:

> "Sorry to hear you were ill. I hope you're feeling better now. I think you **ought to** help a local business go digital. **How about** helping them set up an online

ordering system? I'm going to help with a project to collect old devices because I feel we **should** recycle old phones."

"Look at Jood's plan," said Mr Saif. "**Say you're sorry. Say which project. Suggest ideas. Tell her your own plan.** One paragraph for each point. And look at the language: ought to, how about, should – **different phrases**. Don't repeat 'You should' in every sentence."

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Hamed's plan

Hamed read Khalid's email again and made notes: 1. sorry you're ill, 2. which project, 3. ideas, 4. my plan.

"Is it **formal** or **informal**?" he asked.

"Khalid is your friend, so **informal**," said Mr Saif. "**Hi + name**, short sentences, a friendly ending."

Hamed's reply

"Hi Khalid,

Sorry to hear you were ill. I hope you're feeling better now.

I think you **should** do the workshops for older adults, because you're very patient.

Why don't you teach them how to make video calls? **You could** also show them how to read the news on a phone.

I'm going to help my uncle's shop go digital. **How about** joining me after your workshop?

Get well soon!

Hamed"

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Improve it

Hamed checked his email with the **Improve it** list:

Does it include **all the information in the notes**? Yes – all four points.

Did I **organise my ideas** clearly into paragraphs? Yes.

Did I use a **variety of phrases** for advice and suggestions? should, why don't you, you could, how about – yes!

Did I check **grammar, spelling and punctuation**? He found "your" and changed it to "you're".

It was about **100 words**.

Khalid answered the next day: "Thanks! I'm going to do the workshops. My grandmother is my first student!"

The end of the month

At the end of Teen Tech Help Month, Khalid's workshop had twelve older adults. Hamed's uncle's shop had an online ordering system. An old man said to Khalid: "Thank you, my son. Now I can see my grandchildren in Canada on video!"

Mr Saif wrote on the board: "**Experience is one thing you can't get for nothing.**" Khalid smiled. He understood. He gave his time, and he got experience.

> 💡 Use different phrases: should, ought to, why don't you, you could, how about.

📖 Words from the story

community مجتمع	**workshop** ورشة عمل
recycle يعيد التدوير	**local business** عمل تجاري محلي
project مشروع	**reply** رد
formal رسمي	**informal** غير رسمي

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Teen Tech Help Month: teenagers help adults in the community with technology
- ✔ Ideas: workshops for older adults, helping a local business go digital, collecting old devices for recycling
- ✔ A reply: say you're sorry, give advice, suggest ideas, tell your own plan
- ✔ Use a variety of phrases and don't repeat You should
- ✔ Include all the information in the notes, one paragraph for each point
- ✔ An informal email: Hi + name, short sentences, friendly ending
- ✔ Write about 100 words, then check grammar, spelling and punctuation

🤔 Little questions

1. What is Teen Tech Help Month?
   Answer: teenagers helping their community with technology
2. How many words should the reply be?
   Answer: about 100
3. Is Jood's email formal or informal?
   Answer: informal
4. Give another phrase for You should.
   Answer: Why don't you / You could / How about
5. How should you start a reply to a friend who was ill?
   Answer: Sorry to hear you were ill. I hope you're feeling better now.

The Drone Over the Mountain Village

Health story · Unit 3: The future is now

👥 Hamed, his aunt who is a nurse, and Majid

Hamed's aunt was a nurse in a mountain village. One day she visited the family and showed them a video on her phone.

"Look," she said. "This is how **technology helps everyone** in **healthcare**."

Telemedicine

"In my village, the hospital is far away," she said. "But with **telemedicine**, people can **talk to doctors without going to a hospital or clinic**. Last week an old man showed his leg to a doctor in Muscat on a video call. The doctor gave advice in five minutes."

"That's **comfortable** for **patients**," said Hamed.

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Wearable devices

Majid looked at the aunt's watch. "Is that a smartwatch?"

"Yes. **Wearable devices** like smartwatches can **count steps**, **check your heartbeat** and **track sleep**. One patient's watch saw a problem with his **heartbeat** and told him to see a doctor. It helped him early."



LESSON 8

UNIT CHECK

Wordlist

Technology in the home p41
air conditioning (*n*)
coffee maker (*n*)
dishwasher (*n*)
fridge-freezer (*n*)
kettle (*n*)
microwave (*n*)
speaker (*n*)
TV (*n*)
washing machine (*n*)

Phrasal verbs p41
come on (*phr v*)
go off (*phr v*)
plug (the printer) in (*phr v*)
set up (a new device) (*phr v*)
switch (the TV) off (*phr v*)
switch (the light) on (*phr v*)
turn (the volume) down (*phr v*)
turn (the sound) up (*phr v*)

Smart homes p41
AI assistant (*n*) p43
app (*n*)
battery (*n*) p42
central heating (*n*)
click (*v*)
device (*n*)
download (*v*)
icon (*n*)
machine (*n*)
robot (*n*) p43
smart speaker (*n*) p39
system (*n*)

Other
challenge (*n*) p39
consume (*v*) p39
create (*v*) p39
digital (*adj*) p39
earphones (*n*) p42
games controller (*n*) p42
headphones (*n*) p42
hologram (*n*) p40
interactive (*adj*) p39
lifelike (*adj*) p39
platform (*n*) p39
predict (*v*) p42
preference (*n*) p39
produce (*v*) p39
regularly (*adv*) p39
screen (*n*) p42
smart watch (*n*) p42
social media (*n*) p38
tablet (*n*) p42
transform (*v*) p39
version (*n*) p39
virtual reality (*n*) p38

Unit 3 wordlist

3D printing and cochlear implants

"**3D printing** is also improving healthcare," the aunt continued. "Doctors can print special parts for patients."

"And this boy in the video?" asked Hamed. "He's smiling and listening to his mother."

"He has a **cochlear implant**. It **changes sounds into signals** and sends them to the **hearing nerve**. Before, he couldn't hear. Now he can hear his mother's voice."

❁ ❁ ❁

Drones

"And the most exciting part," said the aunt. "Last winter, the road to my village was closed by rain. A patient needed blood. A **drone** flew over the mountains and brought it in twenty minutes! **Drones can carry blood and medicine to places that are hard to reach.**"

"Wow!" said Majid. "I'm going to be a drone pilot!"

The project

Mr Saif gave the class a project: design **a new technology for health**.

Hamed and Majid **researched** technologies that already exist. Then they thought of a health problem in their town: old people forget to drink water in the hot summer.

They designed "**WaterWatch**": a smart bottle that lights up and speaks every hour. They wrote **three reasons** why it is useful: it reminds people to drink, it tracks how much they drink, and it can send a message to their family.

They presented it, and the class voted. WaterWatch won second place!

"Think," said Mr Saif, "how could technology help people in **your village or town**?"

❁ ❁ ❁

The unit check

Before the test, the boys reviewed Unit 3 together.

"Are you OK?" asked Majid. "No. Look at the time! I **'m going to be** late! – evidence, going to."

"I **'m meeting** Alice tonight – an arrangement. Not 'I will meet'."

"What **shall** we do on Saturday? – a suggestion. Not 'What we do?'"

"Advice: should, ought to, why don't you, how about, shall."

"Phrasal verbs: switch on, turn up, plug it in. Smart home words: **AI assistant, app, battery, device, robot, system**."

"And the Grammar file on page 56 for future forms."

On the day of the test, Hamed's aunt sent a message: "Good luck! I'm sure you're going to do well."

Hamed smiled. "**Going to** – she has evidence. We studied!"

> 💡 Telemedicine, smartwatches, 3D printing, cochlear implants and drones all improve healthcare.

📖 Words from the story

telemedicine الطب عن بعد	**healthcare** الرعاية الصحية
patient مريض	**heartbeat** نبض القلب
cochlear implant زراعة القوقعة	**drone** طائرة مسيّرة
3D printing الطباعة ثلاثية الأبعاد	**comfortable** مريح
hard to reach يصعب الوصول إليه	**track** يتتبع

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Telemedicine lets people talk to doctors without going to a hospital or clinic
- ✔ Smartwatches can count steps, check heartbeat and track sleep
- ✔ 3D printing is improving healthcare
- ✔ A cochlear implant changes sounds into signals and sends them to the hearing nerve
- ✔ Drones can carry blood and medicine to places that are hard to reach
- ✔ Project: research, find a health problem, describe your technology with three reasons, present it
- ✔ Unit 3 review: future forms, advice and suggestions, phrasal verbs, smart home words

🤔 Little questions

1. What is telemedicine?
   Answer: talking to a doctor without going to a hospital
2. What can drones carry?
   Answer: blood and medicine

3. What can smartwatches do?

   Answer: count steps, check heartbeat and track sleep

4. Correct this for an arrangement: I will meet Alice tonight.

   Answer: I'm meeting Alice tonight.

5. Correct this: What we do on Saturday?

   Answer: What shall we do on Saturday?